

Studies on mental health are inadequate

The **process** of scholarly studies on mental health **needs** to be balanced, **ambitious** and **mindful**.

The **spine-chilling dialogue** “Yeh suicide nahin murder hai sir” in a Bollywood movie **is** still fresh in our minds and getting **renewed** from time to time. The scene of the movie argues to **combat** mental health issues in the academic atmosphere. **One** of the ways to **curb** the **menace** of mental health issues **is** to **foster robust** academic research. Academic research promotes learning by **highlighting** the key issues of society. But unfortunately, this research is a **shambles**.

However, the **dearth** of such research across the globe **remains** a **stark** reality. The **apathy** of academic **probes** toward the issue has not been **duly addressed**. The **precarious** condition of research continues **unabated**. Over the years, scholarly studies on mental health have been **lacklustre**. From several researchers’ **perspectives**, the scholarly **studies** on mental health in the space of research **remain shoddy** and slow-paced and have been **grappling** with certain issues. It is not **confined** to any country; rather such academic **blight** has **contaminated** the academic **fraternity** on a global scale. The scientific probe or research process is **plagued** with **shortcomings** starting from literature review to publication. Literature review has its **standing** in the process of scholarly research. Mostly, studies have been conducted with a quantitative approach, and the **robust** qualitative approach to the topic is de-emphasised. The qualitative narratives on the topic are getting skewed and **lopsided owing** to excessive **stress** on quantitative research methodology. There is an inadequate approach while **deliberating** the topic **in light of** children, women and geographical locations of the subjects.

Mental health **issues** in rural areas **are** not getting **judicious** space in research and publications. **Focus** on issues unique to those living and working in rural areas **is abysmally** missing. The **dichotomy** in terms of studies considering the mental issues of males and females **has** been narrowly **addressed**, neglecting other **sexual orientation** groups. Domestic violence has been excessively placed **in the domain of** scholarly studies about mental health and wellness. Data collection through a qualitative approach remains a **herculean task** that needs to be suitably handled.

Research publication is an **imperative** part of academic research. The structures and processes of universities, research organisations and funding agencies tend to focus on disciplinary expertise and publication outputs, **driven** by the **quest** for research excellence. This arrangement has **arguably** been very **efficacious**, with an increasing number of scientific publications. However, there has been a growing **disparity** between the **global south** and the rest of the world when addressing mental issues. Developing countries do not have adequate publication scopes compared to developed countries. Many **interdisciplinary** journals in developing countries are not **paying minimum heed to** the issues of mental health. There is a time **scarcity** of reviewers. Again, **potential** reviewers are not available in the domain.

Factors like a **dearth** of skilled research supervisors in a particular area **remain** a **stumbling block** in the process of academic research. Mental health research has been underfunded when compared to the global burden of suffering, and little has changed despite words from various funding organizations. Mental health research funding is too little. Sometimes it is not logical and too much of the **meagre** investment is on basic research. The WHO's **clarion call** "Make mental health & well-being for all a global priority" for the current year in celebrating World Mental Health Day is well-deserving. Prioritising mental health will be more **pragmatic** if research and practice **go hand in hand**, and a **holistic** approach to mental well-being can be maintained. [Practice Exercise]

- **Mindful** (adjective) – Aware, conscious, attentive, thoughtful सचेत/ सावधान
- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Ambitious** (adjective) – aspiring, driven, zealous, determined, goal-oriented आकांक्षी
2. **Spine-chilling** (adjective) – terrifying, horrifying, frightening, alarming, shocking रोंगते खड़े कर देने वाला
3. **Renewed** (adjective) – revitalized, refreshed, restored, reestablished, revived नवीकृत
4. **Combat** (verb) – confront, battle, challenge, oppose, counter संघर्ष करना
5. **Curb** (verb) – restrain, control, suppress, hold back, check रोकना
6. **Menace** (noun) – threat, danger, peril, hazard, risk खतरा
7. **Foster** (verb) – nurture, promote, encourage, cultivate, develop पोषित करना
8. **Robust** (adjective) – strong, resilient, sturdy, tough, durable मजबूत
9. **Highlight** (verb) – emphasize, underline, spotlight, accentuate प्रमुखता देना
10. **Shamble** (noun) – mess, chaos, disorder, disarray, jumble अव्यवस्था
11. **Dearth** (noun) – shortage, scarcity, lack, deficit, paucity कमी
12. **Stark** (adjective) – blatant, clear, obvious, distinct, evident स्पष्ट
13. **Apathy** (noun) – indifference, disinterest, detachment, lethargy उदासीनता
14. **Probe** (noun) – investigation, inquiry, examination, study जांच
15. **Duly** (adverb) – appropriately, properly, fittingly, rightly उचित रूप से
16. **Address** (verb) – tackle, handle, deal with, attend to सुलझाना, निपटाना
17. **Precarious** (adjective) – unstable, uncertain, insecure, risky अनिश्चित
18. **Unabated** (adjective) – continuous, incessant, relentless, unrelenting निरंतर
19. **Lacklustre** (adjective) – uninspiring, dull, flat, bland, boring बेरंग
20. **Perspective** (noun) – viewpoint, outlook, angle, stance दृष्टिकोण
21. **Shoddy** (adjective) – inferior, poor, substandard, second-rate घटिया
22. **Grapple** (with) (verb) – wrestle, struggle, deal with, confront सामना करना
23. **Confine** (to) (verb) – restrict, limit, restrain, enclose सीमित करना
24. **Blight** (noun) – affliction, curse, scourge, plague अभिशाप
25. **Contaminate** (verb) – pollute, adulterate, taint, defile दूषित करना

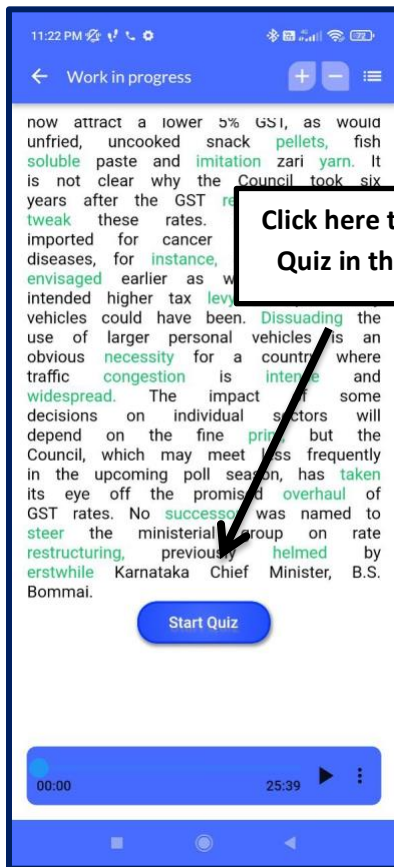
26. **Fraternity** (noun) – Brotherhood, association, guild, sorority, fellowship
समुदाय
27. **Plague** (with) (verb) – Afflict, torment, trouble, bedevil, beset परेशान करना
28. **Shortcomings** (noun) – Weakness, flaw, defect, inadequacy, limitation कमियों
29. **Standing** (noun) – Status, rank, position, reputation, stature स्थिति
30. **Robust** (adjective) – Strong, sturdy, durable, vigorous, tough मजबूत
31. **Lopsided** (adjective) – Uneven, unbalanced, disproportionate, one-sided एकतरफ़ा
32. **Owing to** (phrase) – Because of, due to, as a result of की वजह से
33. **Stress** (noun) – Strain, pressure, tension, anxiety दबाव
34. **Deliberate** (verb) – Contemplate, consider, ponder, think about विचार करना
35. **In the light of** (phrase) – Considering, in view of, taking into account ध्यान में रखते हुए
36. **Judicious** (adjective) – Wise, sensible, prudent, thoughtful समझदार
37. **Abysmally** (adverb) – Extremely, terribly, woefully भयानक तरीके से
38. **Dichotomy** (noun) – Division, split, gulf, breach विभाजन
39. **Sexual orientation** (noun) – A person's identity in relation to the gender or genders to which they are attracted.
40. **In the domain of** (phrase) – In the field of, in the area of के क्षेत्र में
41. **Herculean task** (phrase) – A task that is very difficult or requires a lot of effort विशाल कार्य
42. **Imperative** (adjective) – Crucial, essential, vital, necessary अत्यंत आवश्यक
43. **Drive** (verb) – Cause something to happen
44. **Quest** (noun) – Search, mission, pursuit, exploration, expedition खोज, तलाश
45. **Arguably** (adverb) – Perhaps, possibly, maybe, conceivably शायद
46. **Efficacious** (adjective) – Effective, efficient, potent, powerful फलदायक
47. **Disparity** (noun) – Inequality, discrepancy, imbalance, difference असमानता
48. **Global south** (noun) – Term used to describe lower-income countries, primarily situated in the Southern Hemisphere
49. **Interdisciplinary** (adjective) – Multidisciplinary, cross-disciplinary, integrated अंतर-विषयी
50. **Pay heed to** (phrase) – attend to, take note of, consider, give attention to, regard ध्यान देना

51. **Scarcity** (noun) – shortage, dearth, lack, paucity, deficit कमी
52. **Potential** (adjective) – possible, probable, likely, capable, prospective संभावित
53. **Dearth** (noun) – scarcity, shortage, deficiency, paucity, insufficiency कमी
54. **A stumbling block** (phrase) – hindrance, obstacle, barrier, impediment, obstruction बाधा
55. **Meagre** (adjective) – scanty, limited, insufficient, paltry, sparse अल्प
56. **Clarion call** (phrase) – a strongly expressed demand or request for action. स्पष्ट आह्वान
57. **Pragmatic** (adjective) – practical, realistic, sensible, logical, rational व्यावसिक
58. **Go hand in hand** (phrase) – to be closely related, be connected, coincide, be associated हाथ में हाथ डालकर चलना (मेल-जोल में होना)
59. **Holistic** (adjective) – comprehensive, integrated, all-inclusive, all-encompassing, whole समग्र

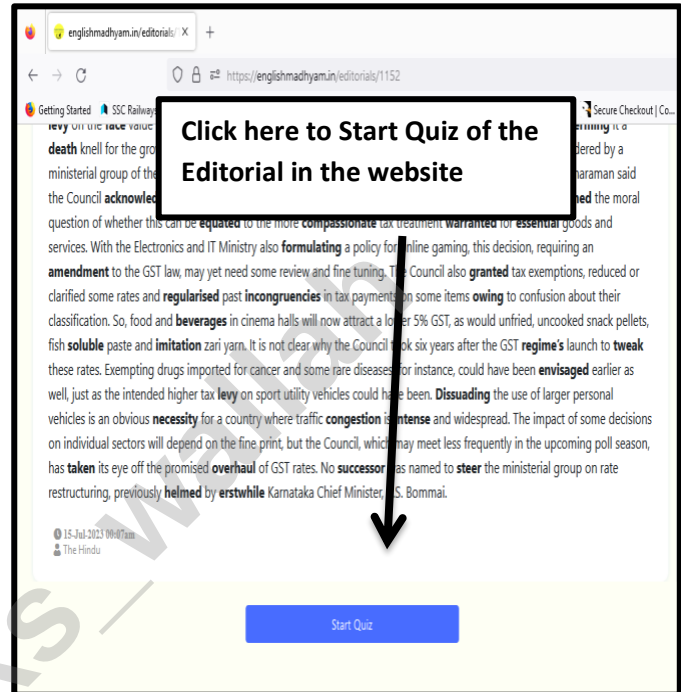
Summary of the Editorial

1. Mental health issues are gaining attention, especially as reflected in popular media like Bollywood.
2. Robust academic research on mental health is essential to address its challenges, but current research is inadequate.
3. There's a global deficiency in academic research on mental health, reflecting negligence toward the issue.
4. The quality and pace of mental health research have been unsatisfactory from the viewpoint of many scholars.
5. These shortcomings are not limited to any one country but are seen worldwide.
6. Research processes, starting from the literature review stage, have flaws, with a significant bias towards quantitative over qualitative methods.
7. Research neglects particular groups like those in rural areas, children, women, and diverse sexual orientations.
8. Although domestic violence is extensively studied in relation to mental health, other equally crucial areas are overlooked.
9. Data collection, especially through qualitative approaches, presents significant challenges.
10. The existing system emphasizes publication outputs and disciplinary expertise, with more scientific publications being produced.
11. There's a disparity in research publication between the global south and the rest, with developing countries lacking adequate publication avenues for mental health topics.
12. Issues like shortage of potential reviewers and lack of skilled research supervisors hinder academic research progress.
13. Funding for mental health research is insufficient, especially considering the global impact of mental health issues.
14. Despite assurances, funding organizations have not adequately addressed the funding gap in mental health research.
15. The World Health Organization emphasizes the importance of mental health, suggesting that effective research and practical approaches are crucial for global mental well-being.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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